Increasing User Engagement and Listening Time for Spotify India

Business Requirements Document (BRD)

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1. Executive Summary

This Business Requirements Document (BRD) defines the business problem of low user engagement and shorter listening sessions among Spotify India users. The objective is to understand the root causes behind low listening time through user research, data analysis, and stakeholder alignment. The document focuses on defining the problem, business goals, scope, and requirements without prescribing specific product solutions.

2. Project Description

Spotify India operates in one of the world's fastest-growing music streaming markets, where user engagement is a key driver of retention and revenue. Current analysis indicates that users spend less time listening compared to desired business targets. This BRD aims to identify the factors contributing to lower engagement, analyze user behaviour across different segments, and define business requirements that will guide future product improvements while aligning Product, Design, Engineering, and Analytics teams. This document thoroughly defines the core problem space, establishes project scope boundaries, and outlines comprehensive business requirements without prematurely proposing detailed product solutions. A core focus is placed on analyzing drop-off points to ensure our strategy directly supports the end user's needs.

Current State Observation	Expected Future Outcome
Users report repetitive song recommendations.	Dynamic algorithms adapt to user moods and regional tastes.
Frequent drop-offs after 2-3 songs on free tier.	Extended session duration driven by smoother transitions.
Regional content discovery is manual and friction-heavy.	Automated surfacing of hyper-local music choices.

3. Project Scope

In Scope	Out of Scope
• Analyze user engagement and listening behavior across Spotify India. • Identify factors contributing to reduced listening time. • Segment users based on demographics, subscription type, device, and listening behavior. • Map the current user journey and identify engagement drop-off points. • Define business requirements, assumptions, constraints, and success metrics. • Establish KPIs to measure business outcomes.	• UI/UX design and high-fidelity prototypes. • Technical architecture and implementation details. • Music licensing and content acquisition decisions. • Pricing strategy and subscription model changes. • Marketing campaign execution. • Expansion beyond the Indian market.

4. Business Drivers

Strategic Driver
Increase Spotify India's competitiveness by improving user engagement and strengthening user loyalty in the Indian music streaming market.

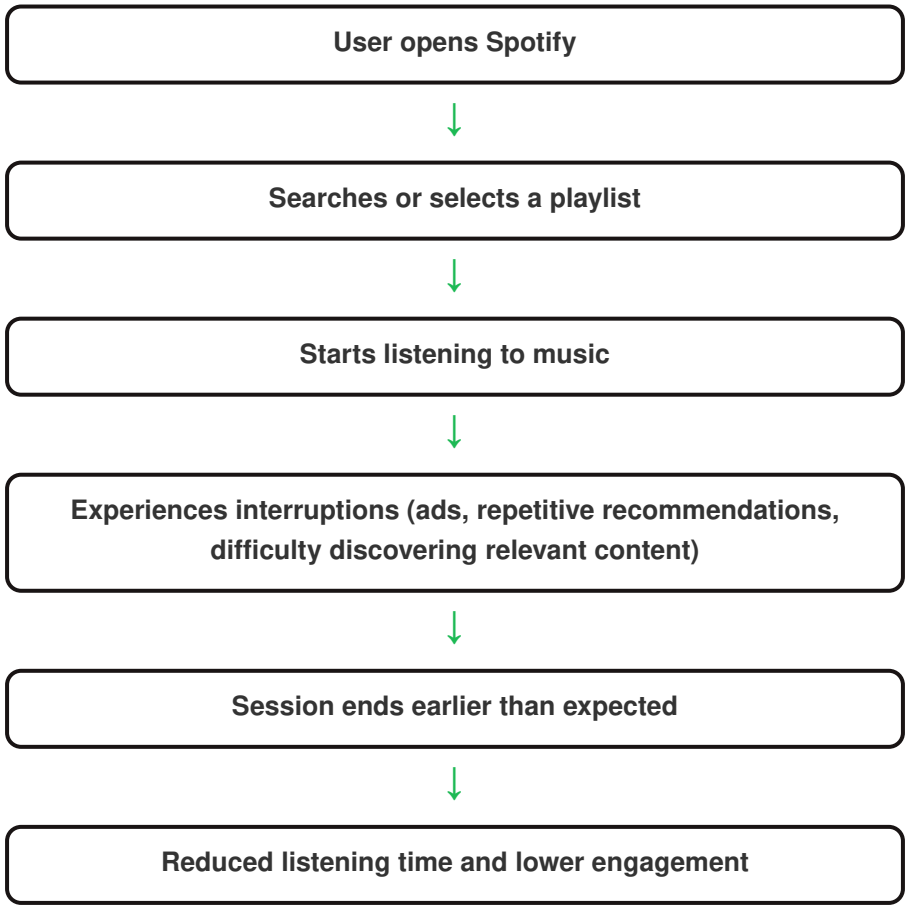
Business Driver
Increase average listening time to improve user retention, Premium subscription conversions, and advertising revenue.

Customer Driver
Deliver a more personalized and seamless listening experience that better meets the needs of diverse Indian user segments.

Operational Driver
Provide clear business requirements that align Product, Design, Engineering, Analytics, and Business teams throughout the project lifecycle.

5. Current Process

Understanding how users currently interact with the platform highlights the exact moments where engagement is lost.

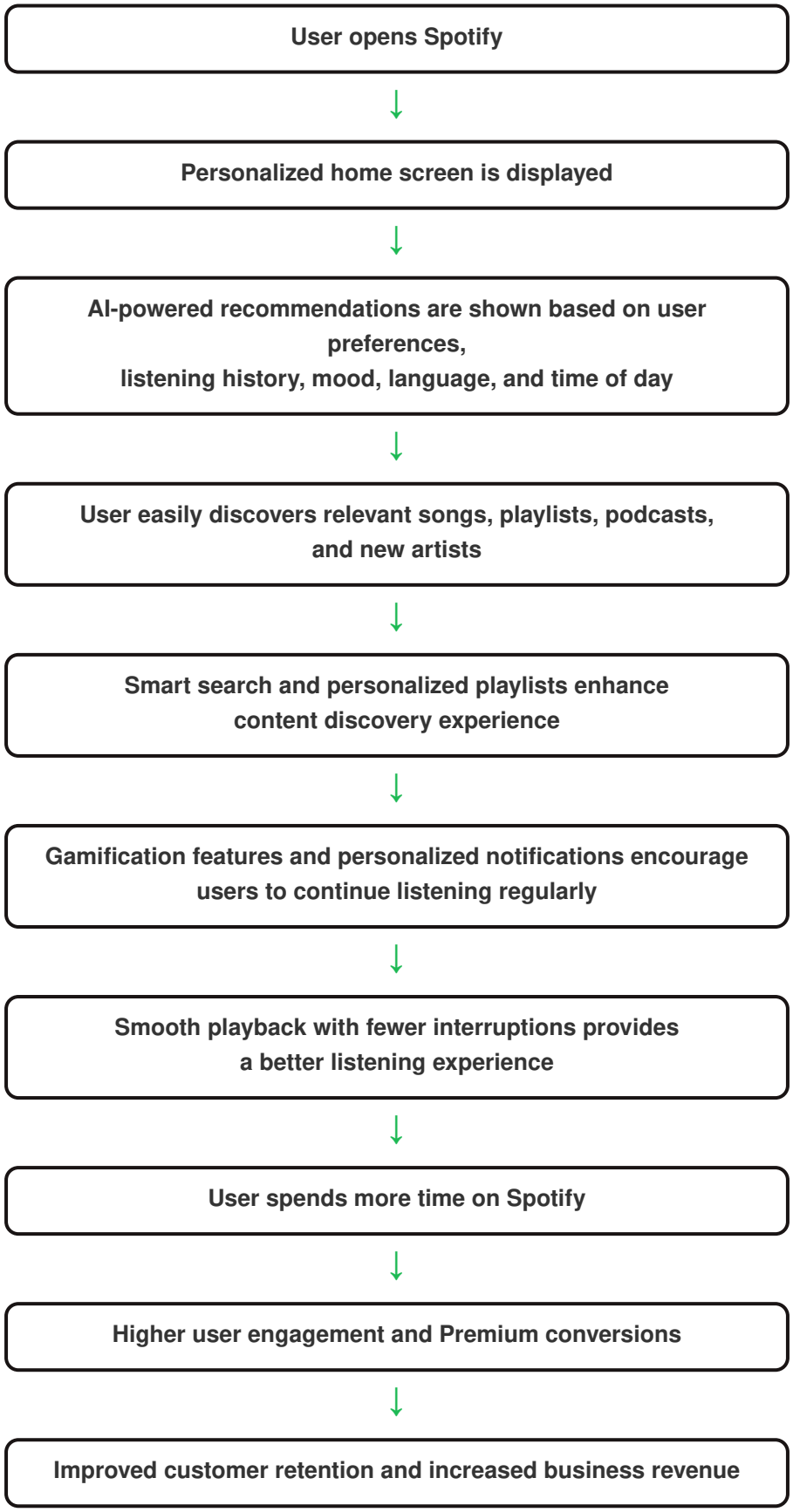


Current Pain Points Identified:

- Users struggle to discover relevant regional and personalized content.
- Repetitive recommendations reduce user engagement over time.
- Free-tier interruptions negatively impact the listening experience.
- Listening sessions end prematurely, reducing overall platform engagement.

6. Proposed Process

Understanding how users will interact with Spotify after implementing the proposed enhancements demonstrates how the solution improves engagement, listening time, and overall business outcomes.



7. Functional Requirements

Priority	Functional Requirement	Business Rationale
Critical	The system shall capture and analyze user listening behavior across different user segments.	Identify engagement patterns and user preferences.
Critical	The system shall identify session drop-off points and measure listening duration.	Understand where and why users stop listening.
High	The system shall support user segmentation based on subscription type, device, region, language, and demographics.	Enable targeted business analysis.
High	The system shall track user interactions such as skips, searches, playlist completion, and repeat listening.	Measure engagement and identify friction points.
Medium	The system shall generate engagement reports and dashboards for business stakeholders.	Support data-driven decision making.
Medium	The system shall monitor key engagement KPIs on a periodic basis.	Measure project success against business objectives.

8. Non-Functional Requirements

Attribute	Requirement	Business Need
Performance	The system shall provide accurate engagement reports with minimal processing delay.	Enable timely business decisions.
Scalability	The system shall support analysis for millions of active users across India.	Support future user growth.
Reliability	Engagement data shall be accurate, consistent, and available for reporting.	Ensure trustworthy business insights.
Security	User data shall comply with the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act and Spotify's privacy policies.	Protect user privacy and meet legal requirements.
Usability	Business dashboards and reports shall be easy to understand for non-technical stakeholders.	Improve stakeholder adoption and decision-making.
Availability	Analytics and reporting services shall be available whenever required by business teams.	Support continuous monitoring of KPIs.

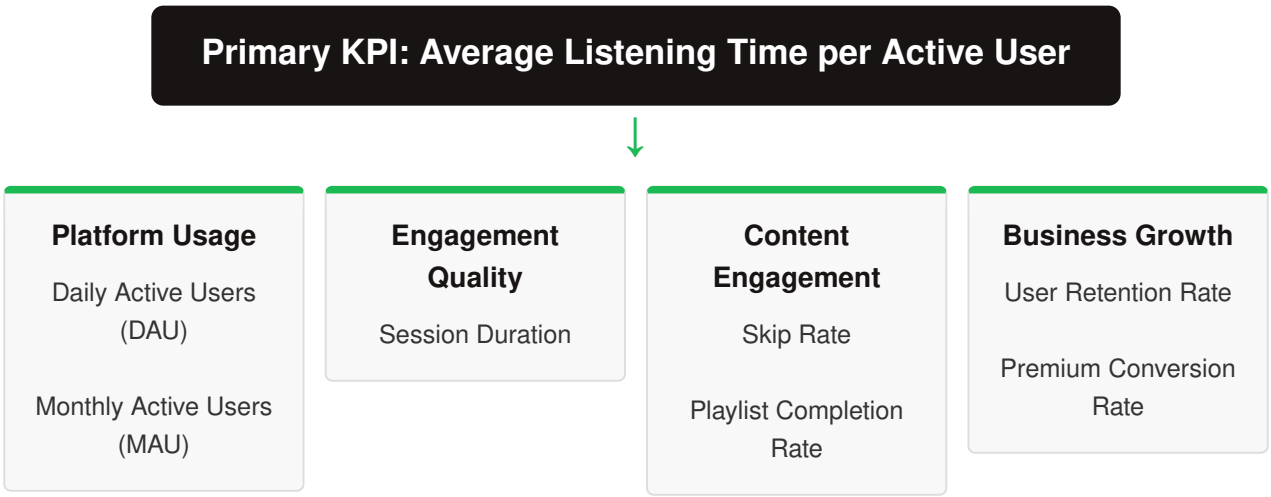
9. Assumptions and Constraints

Assumptions	Constraints
• Users are willing to spend more time listening if friction points are reduced. • User behavior data accurately represents engagement patterns. • Existing analytics systems provide reliable data for decision-making. • Stakeholders will be available for requirement validation and feedback.	• Limited project timeline and development resources. • Budget limitations for research and implementation. • Music licensing agreements may restrict certain product improvements. • Compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act and other applicable regulations.

10. Success Criteria & KPIs

Success Criteria

- Increase average listening time per active user by 15%.
- Improve user retention by 10%.
- Increase Premium subscription conversion by 5%.
- Reduce early session drop-offs by 20%.
- Improve user satisfaction based on engagement metrics and feedback.



KPI Reference Table

KPI	Why it Matters
Average Listening Time	Measures overall engagement.
Daily Active Users (DAU)	Tracks daily platform usage.
Monthly Active Users (MAU)	Measures active user base.
Session Duration	Indicates quality of engagement.
User Retention Rate	Shows long-term user loyalty.
Premium Conversion Rate	Measures business growth.
Skip Rate	Identifies user dissatisfaction.
Playlist Completion Rate	Measures content engagement.

11. Timeline & Milestones

Phase	W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	Key Activities
Discovery & Research (Duration: Week 1)						User research, competitor analysis, stakeholder interviews
Problem Framing (Duration: Week 2)						User journey, pain points, problem statement
Requirements Gathering (Duration: Week 3)						Functional & Non-Functional Requirements, KPIs
BRD Review (Duration: Week 4)						Stakeholder review and feedback
Final Submission (Duration: Week 5)						Approved BRD

12. Stakeholders

Role	Primary Responsibility in Project
Product Manager	Defines business objectives and priorities
Business Analyst	Gathers, analyzes and documents requirements
UX/UI Designer	Improves user experience based on requirements
Data Analytics Team	Provides data insights and KPI tracking
Engineering Team	Evaluates technical feasibility and implementation
Business Leadership	Reviews and approves project direction
Marketing Team	Aligns engagement initiatives with business strategy

13. Cost & Benefit

Estimated Cost

- User Research
- Data Analytics
- Product & Design Effort
- Engineering Development
- Testing & Validation

Expected Benefits

- Increased listening time
- Improved user retention
- Higher Premium conversions
- Increased advertising revenue
- Better customer satisfaction

14. Glossary

Term	Definition
BRD	Business Requirements Document
KPI	Key Performance Indicator
DAU	Daily Active Users
MAU	Monthly Active Users
User Retention	Percentage of users who continue using Spotify over time
Session Duration	Average listening time per session
Premium Conversion	Percentage of Free users upgrading to Premium

15. References

- Spotify Annual Report (2025/2026)
- Spotify India User Research (Milestone 1)
- Deloitte Digital Media Trends Report
- PwC Entertainment & Media Outlook
- Google Play Store Reviews
- Apple App Store Reviews
- Competitor Analysis (JioSaavn, YouTube Music, Gaana)